

Permission-Based Cold Call Opener

Script - Skill: opening - Difficulty: beginner - Est. 6 min

Draft resource pending human editorial review - not yet professionally verified.

A short, honest opener that asks for a few seconds of attention before you explain why you called, so the conversation starts with consent instead of a pitch.

Learning objectives

- Introduce yourself clearly and say who you are with
- Ask permission before continuing
- Give a specific, honest reason for the call
- End with one open question that invites a real answer

How to use it

1. Read the four beats out loud until they feel natural: identity, permission, reason, question.
2. Replace the bracketed placeholders with your own company and a real, specific reason for calling.
3. Practice the opener five times before your first live call of the day.
4. If the prospect says now is not a good time, offer to be brief or to call back - do not push past a clear no.

The four beats

- Identity: "Hi [name], this is [you] with [company]."
- Permission: "Can I borrow 30 seconds to tell you why I called, and then you can decide if it is worth continuing?"
- Reason: one specific, honest sentence about why you are calling this person.
- Question: an open question that lets them react in their own words.

Worked example

"Hi Jordan, this is Sam with Northlight. Can I borrow 30 seconds to tell you why I called, and then you can decide if it is worth continuing? ... Thanks. I work with operations leads at mid-size logistics firms, and most tell me onboarding new drivers still runs on spreadsheets. Before I assume that is true for you - how are you handling that today?"

Safe-practice note

Never claim a referral, prior meeting, or relationship that did not happen. If the prospect says it is a bad time, respect it and offer to reconnect. Rehearse with the AI Coach, not with real prospects you have not researched.

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